

SKILLS GUIDE



Excellent verbal communication skills to promote properties to potential clients.



Flexibility to deal with a variety of challenging negotiations between a wide range of clients.



The ability to understand the requirements of potential clients and adapt responses accordingly.



Organizational skills to deal with many sales or rentals going through at the same time.



Awareness of current commercial trends and escalating or declining prices in the property market.



ASSISTANT BRANCH MANAGER

Assists the branch manager with the overall running of a real estate agency. Has a proven track record in sales, valuation, and property listing.



BRANCH MANAGER

Handles the branch's staff and administration, and is responsible for increasing the profitability of the branch.



AGENCY DIRECTOR Owns or runs a real estate agency, overseeing all aspects of the business, from employing staff to attracting new clients in both the sales and rental property markets.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **COST ENGINEER** *see pp. 198–199*
- ▶ **DOMESTIC ENERGY ASSESSOR** Calculates how much energy a property uses and comes up with ways to make it more energy-efficient. They make recommendations to homeowners to save them money on their energy bills.
- ▶ **PROPERTY DEVELOPER** Buys, improves, then sells properties to make money. May invest in a wide range of properties, from new developments to homes requiring renovation, before selling them for a profit.
- ▶ **REAL ESTATE ATTORNEY** Handles all of the legal matters involved in the sale and purchase of properties. They must pass related exams before they can start practicing.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Marketing • Sales • Property • Customer service • Real estate management • Business studies • English



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS After leaving high school or college, you begin as a trainee with a company, which may provide induction courses.



LIFESTYLE Outside of regular office hours, you will likely need to attend property viewings in the evenings and on weekends.



LOCATION Real estate agents usually deal with properties within a defined location. The flexibility to travel quickly to properties in that area is essential.



THE REALITIES Intense pressure to meet sales targets. Basic salaries are often low (or nonexistent) and supplemented by commissions.